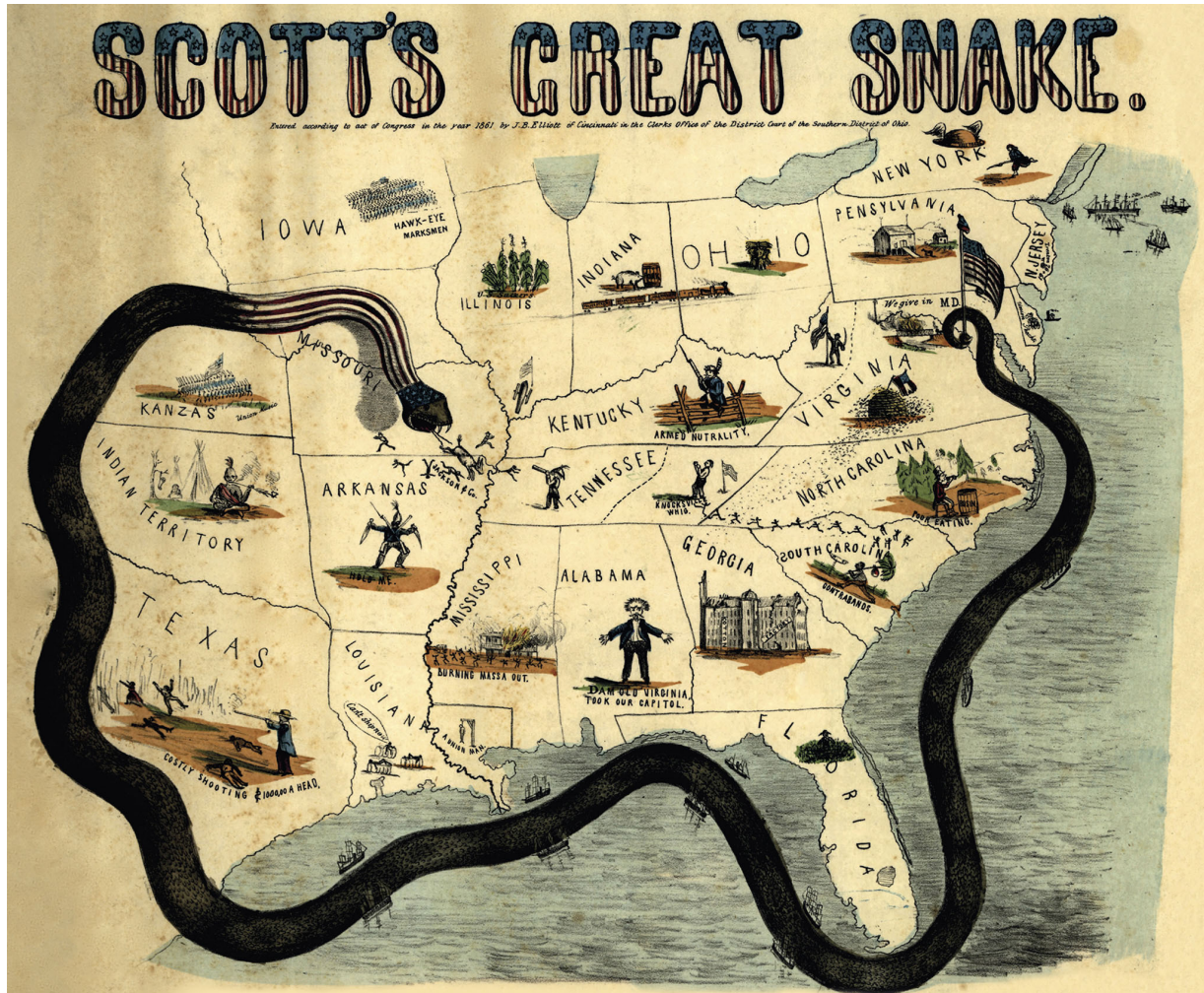


In the North, meanwhile, the veteran, 75-year-old General in Chief Winfield Scott, before his retirement in November 1861, had helped formulate a war strategy, dubbed the Anaconda Plan, that included a naval blockade and the capture of the Mississippi River. This would result in significant Federal victories during the spring of 1862, when the port of New Orleans and much of Tennessee fell to the Union.



Winfield Scott's "Anaconda Plan"

Scott advocated winning the war by a gradual strategy, likened to the crushing attack of a snake, based on blockading the South's ports and then cutting it in two with offensives up and down the Mississippi River.